region in order to establish Palestine as a single nation under Arab control.

Having no desire to find itself at war with Britain, the League decided that no action would be taken immediately but that as soon as the British mandate ended at midnight on May 14, a massive Arab force would launch a coordinated invasion of Palestine. The force that would take part in this invasion included troops and equipment from five nations.

King Abdullah I of Jordan had raised a force of 10,000 men, provided with British equipment and trained by British soldiers. This army was known as the Arab Legion. King Farouk I of Egypt, keen on maintaining Egypt's status as the dominant power in the Arab world, was willing to deploy elements of the Egyptian Army for the invasion. The Iraqi prime minister, Nuri al-Said, was interested in expanding Iraqi influence in the region and was prepared to use elements of the Iraqi Army in the effort. Both Syria and Lebanon agreed to provide troops to support the invasion as well. Although there is no doubt that these Arab leaders wished to see the creation of a Palestinian state and bitterly opposed the creation of Israel, all were also interested in the possibility of bringing the fertile lands of Palestine under their own control.

Compared to the forces available to the IDF, this combined Arab army wasn't just much larger; it was incomparably better equipped, with tanks, heavy artillery, combat aircraft, and large stocks of small arms and ammunition. Few members of the League doubted that, if they did launch an invasion, they would rapidly defeat the ill-equipped IDF. Still, it should be remembered that although the Arab armies coordinated their plans to some degree, this was far from a single, unified force.

For example, King Abdullah of Jordan was a direct rival of Grand Mufti Amin al-Husayni, the leader of the Palestinian independence movement. While King Abdullah did not want to see Palestine fall wholly under Israeli control, neither did he want to see Palestine under the complete control of the grand mufti. Instead, he expected the Arab Legion to establish control over parts of Palestine that could then be incorporated into Jordan. Egypt, Syria, and Iraq also all had their own territorial ambitions in Palestine that were often in competition with the ambitions of the other Arab states. This disunity and lack of a single overriding set of war aims would cause